

r/aiwars

How much energy, water and overall resources does AI actually eat up?

Posted by u/Soggy-Efficiency-399 • 0 points • 40 comments

I am surprised I still see this argument being tossed around coming from environmentalist anti-ai people. Are there some new statistics I'm not aware of?

Comments

u/soloefie • 1 points • 2025-12-17 18:49 UTC

I feel like people are looking at this on a scale so grand it makes it look unimportant. Let's take Texas (my state) as an example. There's a very real concern with Texans that our grid will fail (again), due to the increase in data centers. We already are failing in the water department, and voted to HOPEFULLY put more money into that, but consider how much less concern there would be if these data centers hadn't been built due to the demand of AI? As of 2024, data centers were consuming AT least, 8.8% of the states power. Yes, not all of it is due to AI, but a LARGE percentage is.

How does this affect local community? Texas freeze in 2021 directly/indirectly killed 200+ people. Maybe that's nothing to y'all, but it was significant to us. It's what leads to this concern of how increased data centers stealing our power will impact our grid. Another failure means more deaths.

u/alpha_maus • 1 points • 2025-11-07 09:50 UTC

y'all may wanna read that: <https://www.technologyreview.com/2025/05/20/1116327/ai-energy-usage-climate-footprint-big-tech/>

u/BlindRumm • 1 points • 2025-06-29 00:57 UTC

I wonder if people complain about this with brainrot hedonist things like.. idk, tik tok? Which prob takes the energy of an avg city to run everyday.

u/InspectorSpiceThyme • 1 points • 2025-06-27 09:53 UTC

https://www.lemonde.fr/economie/article/2025/05/19/intelligence-artificielle-le-francais-mistral-ai-et-le-fonds-emirati-mgx-associes-dans-un-projet-de-data-center-geant_6607235_3234.html

French article, Mistral is investing in a datacenter (probably for training and inference) that will eat the equivalent of 1 last-gen nuclear powerplant (1.6GW). For context, this represents 3% of France's current energy generation.

u/Corren_64 • 1 points • 2025-06-26 08:30 UTC

1000 pictures at 720p take around 2 to 3 kWh.

<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2311.16863.pdf>

That source came, funnily enough, from an anti from a discord server I am in and they thought it meant every single picture takes like 3 kWh. And that the "per 1000" just meant the sample size is 1000.

When I said that I doubt that because my 5080 can churn out a 720p in around 10 seconds and it's TDP is less than 500W, they got quiet real quick.

u/Kiragalni • 1 points • 2025-06-26 07:25 UTC

It's less than 1 tree, actually. Depends on how much efficient is energy setup. But realistically people don't use trees for energy. It's more valuable as construction material.

u/Kiragalni • 1 points • 2025-06-26 07:20 UTC

This theme is so common you can get a lot of data about energy consumption. But it looks like you don't need it. Instead you will post this...

u/Alex51423 • 1 points • 2025-06-25 01:10 UTC

Negligible, negligible and negligible. Problems with AI are multiple, but resources are not those.

The language we use w.r.t. AI is simply inadequate. We give them traits they cannot have. We personalize glorified word and image processors. This is a problem since it's delusional (and therefore dangerous), it can create parasocial relationships damaging our society, alienating in a false sense of belonging those requiring help and validating everyone, including those who should never be validated.

Water is not a problem. Energy also.

And anyone claiming it can replace PhDs (while training on PhDs, Altman does that trying to replace us) is just plain malicious. No amount of mimicking 'PhD output' will give you PhD output. I have the most creative thoughts while having a dump and then it takes month to refine and publish. Everything they learn is just the known canon. Trillion words cannot produce new theory, it's a tool, but not a researcher.

And if I am wrong, well, I will eat my words. LLM are word processors